# Ronald E. Straight

## Senior Software Engineer

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### SUMMARY

I bring decades of experience in high-performance backend engineering, from C and Perl to modern Golang and Kubernetes-native Java and Rust microservices. AI coding agents are good collaborators, but they still need someone to tell them when they're about to rimraf something important — with agentic coding you get my unique human experience plus a team of masochistic junior engineers to do all the boring stuff. Work is where I want to swim with my fellow clever rubber ducks.

### SKILLS

**Programming Languages**
Bash, Java, Perl, Golang, C, Python, Rust, Javascript

**Technologies**
Kubernetes, Git, HTML, CSS, REST API, OCI, AWS, Helm, Docker, Node.js, LLM

**Databases**
Oracle, MySQL, PostgreSQL, MariaDB, Redis, MongoDB

**Frameworks**
Mason, DBIx::Class, Netty, Dropwizard, React, Spring Boot

**Coding Agents**
Claude, Codex, OpenClaw, Aider, Antigravity

### WORK EXPERIENCE

**Senior Software Engineer** at Synacor — **Feb 2019 - Oct 2024**

**Buffalo, NY**

- Served as primary developer for the Golang-based Mailbox Locator Service, part of a global team converting the Zimbra email/collaboration system to a multi-tenant Kubernetes-native service on Oracle Cloud Infrastructure.
- Contributed to core Zimbra engineering, working on legacy Java codebase with extensive use of remote debuggers.
- Leveraged Golang and Kubernetes expertise to migrate several hundred million user mailboxes — containing sensitive personal communications — from bare-metal servers to Zimbra on Kubernetes, maintaining data integrity throughout.

**Senior Software Engineer** at Adblade / Solve Media — **May 2013 - Jan 2019**

**Buffalo, NY**

- Built a high-availability RESTful Data Management Platform (DMP) using Java/Netty, supporting sub-millisecond responses at scale.
- Developed custom dispatching annotations and supported multiple HTTP methods for consumer targeting resources stored in Redis.
- Ported a legacy image conversion REST server from Ruby to Java and migrated a Solaris data center environment to AWS.

**Software Engineer III, Team Leader** at Kanoodle / Pulse360 / Seevast — **Nov 2004 - Apr 2013**

**Buffalo, NY**

- Contributed Oracle-specific enhancements upstream to the DBIx::Class open-source ORM framework while developing heavy Perl ad-serving applications.
- Performed Oracle DBA duties, including DDL review and Oracle analytic functions.
- Created a 'RoboDeploy' system for multi-threaded deployment to over 100 servers.

**Co-Founder, Software Developer** at Netsville — **Jun 1994 - Nov 2004**

**Rochester, NY**

- Co-founded Netsville and developed 'Hazel,' one of the first e-commerce checkout systems, written in C with a templating language (HZML).

### PROJECTS

**Logodal** **Jan 2026 - Current**

https://logodal.com

**Skills:** Kubernetes,Minikube,Helm,Perl,Rust,React,Networking,Antigravity,Claude,Codex

Multiplayer whimsical word game running on a kind cluster in my bedroom. In active development.

- Developed a custom wordlist server in Rust to handle building lexicons and their rules for any language.
- Configured networking and TLS termination for public access to the local Kubernetes cluster at logodal.com.
- Implemented real-time gameplay mechanics using Perl, plus simple intelligent dummy players.
- Use in-cluster ollama to generate personalized quips for the AI players

**Card Shoggoths** **Jan 2026 - Current**

https://poker.fazigu.org

**Skills:** Kubernetes,Minikube,Helm,Golang,Networking,Antigravity

Multiplayer poker game with a bit of cosmic horror. In active development.

- Implemented the game server in Golang, with a bare bones index.html/css frontend.
- Configured networking for public access to the local Kubernetes cluster at poker.fazigu.org.

## INTERESTS

### Personal Interests

**Skills:**
Hacking (in the ESR sense),
Tinkering with gadgets,
Fallout/76, Starfield, Cyberpunk,
Arguing with AI,The Love Boat